SawaLove Privacy Policy

Effective date: September 23, 2026

SawaLove ("we", "us") operates a dating service for people in Cameroon and the diaspora. This policy explains what data we collect, why, and the controls you have. **You must be at least 18 years old to use SawaLove.**

1. Data we collect

- **Account data** — the phone number (with +237 prefix) or email address and name you register with. Phone numbers are used to send one-time verification codes by SMS.
- **Profile data** — photos you upload, your bio, age, city/region, relationship intent, religion, and matching preferences.
- **Location** — with your permission, a coarse location used to compute distance to other profiles. Your exact position is never shown to other users; distance is resolved to city/region level.
- **Photos** — profile photos that you choose to upload. The minimum is two photos with a clear face so other users can recognise you.
- **Messages** — if/when messaging is enabled, the messages you send to people you have matched with are stored so both of you can see the conversation.
- **Reports & moderation** — if you report a user, or a user reports you, we store the report, its reason, any details you add, and the moderation decision, to keep the community safe.
- **Transaction PIN** — if you set one, it is sent over TLS and stored only as a salted bcrypt hash. We never store the raw PIN.
- **Device & diagnostics** — basic device information and app version for troubleshooting and security.

2. How we use data

- Create your account and verify your phone number or email.
- Show your profile to other users and match you with people near you.
- Keep SawaLove safe: reviewing reports, pausing or banning accounts that violate our rules, and letting you appeal.
- Let you pause, delete, or export your account data.
- Improve the service using anonymised, aggregated statistics — only if you opt in on the consent screen. You can change this at any time.

3. What we never do

- We never sell your personal data.
- We never post anything anywhere on your behalf.
- We never show your exact GPS position to other users.

4. Camera, microphone, location & notifications

These permissions are optional and requested with an explanation:

- **Location** — to find matches near you. You can use SawaLove without it.
- **Camera** — to take profile photos and verification selfies.
- **Microphone** — to record voice notes in chats (when messaging is on).
- **Notifications** — to tell you about new matches and messages. You can turn these off any time in system settings.

Granting or denying a permission never blocks you from using the rest of the app.

5. Data retention & deletion

- **Delete account** (Profile → Account) schedules permanent deletion of your profile, photos, matches and messages. Recovery is possible for 30 days by contacting support; after that everything is erased.
- **Pause account** hides your profile from discovery until you resume it.
- **Download your data** (Profile → Account) gives you an export of your profile, matches and chats in JSON format.
- Declining the consent screen at signup deletes everything you entered and returns you to the welcome screen.

6. Security

Data travels over HTTPS. Session tokens are stored on your device and expire automatically. Passwords and transaction PINs are stored only as salted hashes. Access to moderation tools is restricted to authorised moderator accounts, and every action is logged.

7. Your rights

You may access, correct, export, or delete your personal data at any time from inside the app, or by emailing **support@sawalove.cm**. Users in the EU/EEA have additional rights under the GDPR, including the right to lodge a complaint with a supervisory authority.

8. Children

SawaLove is strictly for adults aged 18 and over. We do not knowingly collect data from anyone under 18. If you believe a minor is using SawaLove, report the profile in-app or email **support@sawalove.cm** and we will remove it.

9. Changes & contact

We will announce material changes to this policy in the app before they take effect. Questions? Email **support@sawalove.cm**.
